

Fundamental Algorithm Techniques

Problem Set #8

Problem 1 — SCC and reversal .

1. Algorithm to compute the reversal $\text{rev}(G)$ in $O(V+E)$

Idea: reverse every directed edge.

Algorithm:

Create a new graph $\text{rev}(G)$ with the same vertices.

For every edge $(u \rightarrow v) \in E$, add edge $(v \rightarrow u)$ to $\text{rev}(G)$.

Time complexity:

Each vertex and edge is processed once $\rightarrow O(V+E)$.

2. Prove that $\text{scc}(G)$ is acyclic

Proof:

In the SCC graph, each strongly connected component is compressed into a single node.

If there were a cycle between SCCs, then all nodes in the cycle would be mutually reachable.

This contradicts the maximality of SCCs.

Conclusion:

The SCC graph is a Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG).

3. Prove that $\text{scc}(\text{rev}(G)) = \text{scc}(G)$

Proof:

Two vertices u and v are in the same SCC if and only if:

$$u \rightarrow^* v \text{ and } v \rightarrow^* u \text{ in } G.$$

Reversing all edges does not change mutual reachability.

Therefore, SCCs remain unchanged.

Conclusion:

$$\text{scc}(\text{rev}(G)) = \text{scc}(G)$$

4. Reachability between SCCs

Statement:

If there is a path from u to v in G , then there is a path from $S(u)$ to $S(v)$ in $\text{scc}(G)$.

Proof:

Every path in G corresponds to a sequence of SCCs.

Compressing vertices into SCCs preserves reachability.

Thus, reachability is preserved at the SCC level.

Conclusion:

Reachability in G implies reachability in the SCC graph.

Problem 2 — Euler Tour

1. Condition for existence of Euler tour

Statement:

A strongly connected directed graph has an Euler tour iff

$$\text{in-degree}(v) = \text{out-degree}(v) \quad \forall v \in V$$

Explanation:

Each time we enter a vertex, we must leave it.

Equality of in-degree and out-degree ensures edges can be paired.

2. Algorithm to find Euler tour in $O(E)$

Algorithm (Hierholzer's Algorithm):

- Start at any vertex.
- Follow unused edges until you return to the start.
- If unused edges remain, start a new cycle from a vertex in the current tour.
- Merge cycles.

Time complexity:

Each edge is used exactly once $\rightarrow O(E)$.

Problem 3 — Topological Sort

Given graph:

$$\{ A \rightarrow B, A \rightarrow C, B \rightarrow C, B \rightarrow D, C \rightarrow E, D \rightarrow E, D \rightarrow F, G \rightarrow F, G \rightarrow E \}$$

Topological sort starting from A

One valid ordering:

$$A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow E \rightarrow F \rightarrow G$$

Another valid topological ordering

$$G \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow D \rightarrow F \rightarrow C \rightarrow E$$

Explanation

A node appears before all nodes it points to.

Multiple correct answers are possible.

Any order respecting dependencies is valid.